

EARTH'S WARRIORS

GLOBE'S CITIZEN: Pachauri wants the world to do more.

Climate change activists gain recognition for their efforts. But with nations still dragging their feet over commitments, IPCC's Pachauri warns that it is either now or never.

■ By Raj Chengappa

He will not have the prefix Nobel Laureate to his name. That privilege would go to the earth's most articulate warrior, Al Gore. Nor will he be feted as the past winners of the Peace Prize have. Or get to jointly share both the honour and money as Mohamed El Baradei, chairman of the International Atomic Energy Agency did along with his organization in 2005. He is the first to acknowledge that he is "a mere functionary" of the Intergovernmental Panel for Climate Change (IPCC) that along with Gore was jointly awarded the prestigious Nobel Prize for Peace 2007.

Yet there is little doubt that the bearded Rajendra Kumar Pachauri, 67, will find a place in history among those who fought valiantly to save the planet from a certain environmental catastrophe. The irony was that when he took over as IPCC chairman in April 2002, Gore was dead against his ascension. Gore had favoured the continuance of his friend Bob Watson whom Pachauri defeated by a huge margin. The man who could have been the US President did pass some nasty remarks about Pachauri being a George Bush appointee. But since then the two have made up—that would make for a happy picture when Gore and Pachauri, as IPCC chairman, would receive the Nobel in Stockholm on its behalf in December.

Pachauri took over the IPCC at a critical juncture. Functioning since 1988, the panel was set up by two UN agencies to scour through the mass of scientific, technical and socio-economic data and assess the impact of anthropogenic climate change and how to

